

ANNA NAGAR

Purasawalkam » Villivakkam » Kolathur » Nazarathpettai » Pattabiram » Maduravoyal » Koyambedu » Tiruverkadu » Puzhal » Kilpauk » Perambur » Mogappair

Avadi » Ayyapakkam » Tiruninravur » Nerkundram » Moolakadai » Ayanavaram » Retteri » Padi » Ambattur » Tirumullaivoyal » Aminjikarai » Vysarpadi » Red Hills

Recurrent sewage overflow at key road in Perambur



The junction of Saraswathi Street on Perambur High Road - North in Perambur on August 18, 2026. PHOTO: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT.

RAGHUKUMAR CHOODAMANI

The image shows sewage overflowing from a stormwater drain on Perambur High Road - North on August 18, 2026. This spot is near the intersection of Saraswathi Street and Perambur High Road - North. The overflow of sewage was recurrent last week following the recent spells of rain.

Every time residents registered a complaint, GCC workers would arrive to attend to the problem.

A super sucker and a jet-rod machine would have to be employed to contain the flow.

Meanwhile, a team from Zone 6 - Thiru Vi Ka Nagar of the Greater Chennai Corporation started to trace the source of the flow and therefore dug up the road at multiple locations.

The recent search exercise brought to light the deplorable status of the stormwater drain network on this road which is two-and-a-half decades-old. Silt had accumulated in some sections and sewage was found in other sections.

Illegal discharge of sewage, illegal ramps constructed over the manholes of stormwater drains, structural flaws, lack of linking of SWDs, and poor maintenance have all rendered the stormwater drain network on Perambur High Road - North ineffective.

Yet another observation: GCC officials were clueless about the SWD network on this road as there was no map to guide them and the local residents had to help them.

All these point to apathy of the administration.

Raghukumar Choodamani is the convenor of Perambur Neighbourhood Development Forum

'COOKING UP' A CHALLENGE FOR WOMEN CHEFS

Over 70 participants took part in this competition designed to test their culinary knowledge and kitchen skills **P6**



TICKING ON BEHIND THE BARRICADES

Zenith Watch Co in Mylapore has never had a change of address. In recent times, it has been facing a massive challenge on account of Metro Rail work. **P4&5**



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'CTH Road in Mannurpet waits for mending exercise'



Some of the battered sections of CTH Road in Mannurpet.

T. GUNASEELAN

The margins of the Mannurpet section of CTH Road is battered and earthen. On this section, the junction of First Main Road - Ambattur Industrial Estate - South looks the worst.

This is one of the narrow stretches of CTH Road known for heavy traffic congestion and also witnesses heavy waterlogging during rains.

Parking of vehicles and encroachments further eat into the road space. Telecommunication cables lying on the road is yet another menace.

All these make this stretch quite dangerous for pedestrians. The risk of a fatal accident is high on the Mannurpet section of CTH Road.

It is quite disappointing that the widening project of CTH Road (Padi to Thirunindravur covering Korattur, Mannurpet, Amabattur, Thirumullaivoyal, Avadi, and

Pattabiram) announced two decades ago has not made any progress.

There are many accident-prone sections on CTH Road. It may be noted that the Telephone Exchange junction in Ambattur figured in the list of highly dangerous accident-prone spots in a re-

port of National Highways Authority of India for the year 2019. Yet, the project continues to be affected. Successive governments have not taken any step to revive the project.

Likewise, several Madras High Court directives to ensure pedestrian safety have been ignored by the law-enforcing authorities.

Further, the Supreme Court of India in a judgment on June 19, 2026 declared that to walk on de-

marcated and well-maintained footpaths is a fundamental right. The judgment also noted the fundamental right to walk on demarcated footpaths shall override the privilege of a motorised vehicle and authorities are legally mandated to ensure footpaths are free from all types of encroachments.

I request the authorities to attend to this issue at the earliest.

T. Gunaseelan is a resident of Ambattur

Stray cattle 'invasion' at Jayammal street

Roaming of stray cattle is becoming a serious concern at Jayammal Street (near MR Hospital) in Aminjikarai. They hinder the movement of motorists and pedestrians leading to traffic congestion. Further, they litter the road with dung.

These factors raise the risk of accidents. Greater Chennai Corporation should impound these animals and penalise its owners.

F.R. Jemila Sirumalar is a resident of Aminjikarai



Jayammal Street at Aminjikarai. PHOTO: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

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KNOW YOUR NEIGHBOUR

A compass for parents of special children

Villivakkam resident and child behaviour therapist Sharanya Ravichandran's debut book is a reminder that with right guidance and compassion every child can bloom beautifully

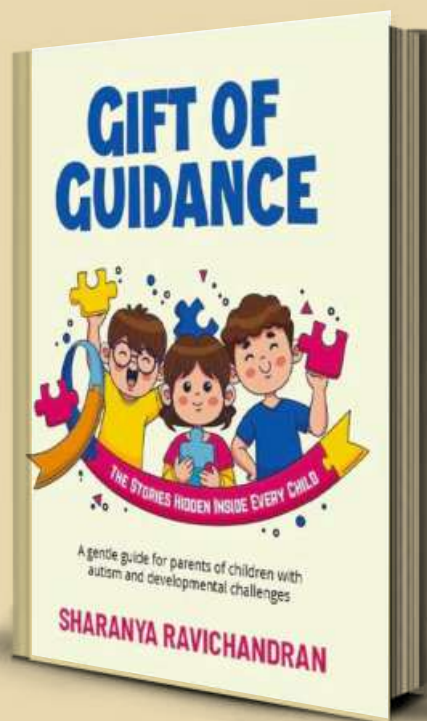
BY A SPECIAL CORRESPONDENT

Here is something written and published for parents trying to come to terms with their child's disability. *Gift of Guidance - The Stories Hidden Inside Every Child* is a guidebook for parents of children with autism and developmental challenges written by Sharanya Ravichandran, a child behaviour therapist.

Ideas put forth with simplicity and lucidity in a "chewable" format, the book draws upon Sharanya's experiences in the field of early intervention. Every chapter ends with a message.

Sharanya runs the Sharanalaya Behavioural Therapy Centre in Villivakkam and has been growing in this field through practice. "Some experiences with children strengthened my clinical reasoning, some refined my intervention strategies and many highlighted the importance of patience, repetition and timing," she says.

Stressing



the role of parents in the progress possible for a special child, she writes: "You do not need perfect English or expensive toys. You need repetition, daily practice, simple routines and patience. Even 15 minutes a day can create change."

Tantrums, she says, happen when children cannot express themselves and this could be the result of fatigue, hunger, confusion or sudden changes. In such situations, the caretaker must stay calm. Jumping, wall push, carrying objects, walking and swinging releases stored energy and prevents tantrums.

Ways to improving listening skills, teaching sharing skills, improving visual memory and building independent skills through daily tasks are featured in the book.

Gift of Guidance is written for parents who noticed something different in their child early on and who searched for answers quietly, says the Villivakkam resident.

The book is priced at ₹499 and special parents can have it at a discount. It can be bought from the centre in Villivakkam. For details, email sharanalayabehaviouraltherapy@gmail.com or call 91591 11222



I-Day celebration



Masjid-e-Dayeyaan, a mosque at Thiru Vi Ka Nagar in Perambur celebrated Independence Day by hoisting the national flag.

On the occasion, the mosque authorities spoke about the freedom movement, says a press release.

Over 20 members took part. Refreshments were distributed.

Students of academy in Mogappair win seven medals



Coach A.R. Ranianisia along with S. Kaneshka (left), A.P. Aryasathar (middle) and K.S. Subhiksha (right)

Students of SDAT Dolphin Swimming Academy in Mogappair won seven medals in the 42nd Sub Junior National Aquatic Championships organised by the Swimming Federation of India, held from August 6 to 9 in Jaipur. Arya Sathar won silver in the 50m, 100m, and 200m in the boys' group two backstroke event, and gold in the 4x100m Freestyle relay. Kaneshka won silver in the 100m Breaststroke in the girls Group 3 event. K.S. Subhiksha won silver in the 4x100 Medley and 4x100 Freestyle.

Coach A.R. Ranianisia along with S. Kaneshka (left), A.P. Aryasathar (middle) and K.S. Subhiksha (right)

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Ticking on behind the barricades

Established in 1954, seller and mender of timepieces Zenith Watch Co at Kutchery Road in Mylapore has never had a change of address. In recent times, it has been facing a massive challenge on account of route diversions and road blockages caused by Metro Rail work. The enterprise however seems to have taken this difficulty in its stride. A little distance away, on the same road is a one-man enterprise Peer & Sons, established in 1963, that repairs watches and clocks; and it displays similar fortitude

LAKSHMY HARIKRISHNAN

Zenith Watch Co at
Kutchery Road in
Mylapore.

Somewhere between the ticking of a century-old pendulum clock and a modern, sleek wrist watch, Zenith Watch Co. on Kutchery Road has ensured two distinct eras of time live side by side. A sweep of the eye taking in the walls of this shop that stares at Metro Rail barricades presents this sumptuous display of the past and the present. The walls are decorated with old, ornate timepieces, repaired and ready for delivery; and these walls also display shelves holding modern wristwatches out of factories and packed ready for sale.

Since 1954, this shop at Kutchery Road, near Luz signal in Mylapore, has been serving customers seeking to preserve timepieces of the past, hallowed by their personal memories, as well as watches and clocks just out of the blocks and dew-fresh in the market.

Founded by Mallick Pasha, the shop has never had a change of address. And even in these difficult times, when Metro Rail work has redrawn pathways, both for pedestrians and motorists, the shop resiliently stays put at this address. Mahaboob Pasha, who runs this family business, points out that even old customers accustomed to walking through the doors of this shop struggle to find their way to those familiar doors, as Metro Rail work has engineered a maze of new pathways through route diversions and blockages. By virtue of the diversity of its services, Zenith depends on revisits by old customers as well as walk-ins by new ones. The “barricades” across Luz Corner, on Kutchery Road and Luz Church Road hinder both processes.



“New customers find it difficult to notice the shop, while the old ones find it difficult to reach the shop,” he says.

But Mahaboob sounds like someone who has taken these challenges in his stride. At 58, this man has spent more than three decades amidst the “chimes of time”, having taken over the reins of the shop when he was in his twenties. Back then for this M.Com graduate, there was no dearth of career options. “This is a family business and I cannot leave it; hence I chose this,” he says. There was a time when he worked alongside the technicians at the shop, as a repairer of timepieces. Today, he sticks to

the management side of the business, leaving the repair of broken and malfunctioning timepieces to the technicians on the rolls. Mahaboob notes spare parts are sourced from Mumbai and Delhi when they are unavailable locally.

On whether a plethora of other devices marking time such as the mobile phone, the laptop and so on have made a dent in the attraction of the wristwatch, his answer is an emphatic ‘no’. Mahaboob observes that it remains firmly where it belongs: on the wrist. Largely for inveterate followers and buyers of new wristwatch models, Zenith stocks up on non-branded wristwatches, largely wallet-friendly.

On retaining his old customer base, Mahaboob notes hospitality on the other side of the counter remains an effective glue keeping that loyalty intact. While valuing face-to-face, in-person interactions, Zenith has ensured the connections are sustained by technology. Its website allows customers to track repairs using their bill numbers; it showcases wristwatches, wall clocks, and other timepieces for sale. So, what is it that sustains Zenith as it is hemmed in by Metro Rail barricades? This probably: keeping stride with technology without losing that personal, human touch.



Alone with the timepieces

At Peer & Sons on Kutchery Road, a son is keeping his father’s memory alive by enthusiastically practising a skill imparted to him by the senior

LAKSHMY HARIKRISHNAN

On that part of Kutchery Road, where the Buckingham Canal flows sluggishly under a bridge, S. Shakil Ahmed operates from a shop smaller than a niche in a dovecote. The shop was once larger, recalls Shakil, but as the owner reclaimed a part of it for another enterprise, it shrunk to its present dimensions. But this small shop still catches the eye for its wall displays: clocks, either *demode* or delectably antique, depending on the eye beholding them. Another eye-catching feature is the enseigne above the entrance that announces the enterprise as Peer & Sons. When quizzed about the name and its homonymic alignment with the iconic P. Orr & Sons on Mount Road, Shakil sounds a tad amused as he offers a reply: obviously, when they see this shop, they know the two are galaxies apart. But when they hear the name ‘Peer & Sons’ over the phone, they would be confused for a split second. And the name was not carefully chosen to evoke that iconic shop, remarks Shakil, just to reflect that it was started by his father S.K. Peer.

S.K. Peer had opened this shop in 1963 and continued in the saddle till his demise in 2008. Shakil relishes reminiscing about the unquestioning obedience with which he followed in his father’s footsteps, not in 2008 but way back in 1991 when the senior was at the height of his prowess as a mender of timepieces and he was just a school student. Shakil joined his father as his understudy in 1991, right after finishing his Class X board exams.

“I did not even wait for my results,” he says with a faint laugh at the memory.

“If my father asked for something, it was always a yes,” states Shakil, his decision driven by a straightforward logic: if his father needed him at the shop, that was reason enough to be there.

He observes that for parents to get a ‘yes’ from their children today, they would have to first answer a gazillion ‘whys’. Shakil, who has three children, two girls and a boy, all of them falling within the Gen Z bracket, is at peace with the current generation’s questioning mindset as they are spoilt for choice in terms of career options, and have information at hand to suss those careers out.

To a question if he ever regrets not having taken a different career path, Shakil’s answer is a ‘no’, but he qualifies it by admitting that on rare occasions,



S. Shakil Ahmed at Peer & Sons on Kutchery Road.

the thought has crossed his mind. That thought most likely occurred during the pandemic and in recent times, on account of Metro Rail work at the Luz Corner (where Kutchery Road meets Luz Church Road meet) restricting access to his shop. That thought gets counterbalanced by his awareness of the benefits of being one’s own boss.

“If there is a function, I can attend it without prior leave complications; if I want to travel, I can take a few days off and do so,” he smiles.

He has commendably built a livelihood just by the practice of the craft of repairing timepieces, has managed to give his children good and meaningful education (the two daughters are in college and the son in school).

After his father’s death in 2008, Shakil has been running the shop in a veritable one-man show spending that vast chunk of his waking hours (that is, from 10.a.m. to 9p.m.), sitting hunched over timepieces, peering at them through a magnifying eyepiece. The punch-in punch-out time is sometimes longer: during the pandemic, he began taking delicate and major repairs home, a habit that has stuck with him ever since. His workbench has witnessed everything from a Seiko to a 1960s Omega; and also those ornate tall, weight-driven pendulum clocks, colloquially called grandfather and grandmother clocks depending on their height and size. His customer base includes collectors of antique clocks. He accepts every timepiece that comes his way, from the grand to the commonplace. Repairs of antique clocks can soak up considerable time.

Availability of spare parts can sometimes pose a challenge. When unable to find spare parts, he has fashioned them himself, says Shakil. But obviously, there is a limit to what you can fashion yourself; the sustainable option is to have dealers who can hand them over to you. On a normal day though, he sources spares from dealers. He also buys old clocks to salvage those parts that are in working order.

Now, the question that stares at any enterprise sustained by successive generations. Would the next generation take the baton from Shakil and continue the legacy started by his father S.K. Peer? His children might likely choose different fields, and Shakil admits the possibility of the business continuing through them being thin. For now, Shakil remains at his bench, turning back time by getting old timepieces ticking again. And he luxuriates in the sweet sound of a timepiece ticking and sounding back to life.

Free and subsidised dialysis service providers in Chennai



LIFFY THOMAS

16 and counting

It was after a stint in Canada that nephrologist Georgi Abraham decided to start a dialysis centre at Chennai in the mid-2000s.

The Tanker Foundation Dialysis Centre started in a humble way at Georgi Abraham’s father-in-law’s house on Poonamalee High Road as it was lying vacant.

As the number of patients seeking dialysis began to shoot up, the Foundation sought a space at Rotary Ambattur Hospital where it got started on the initiative with five machines. Today, the upgraded hospital has 26 machines with 127 patients seeking dialysis under its care.

In the last two decades, this initiative to provide dialysis for patients twice or thrice a week has grown to serve people from various parts of Chennai and beyond. Dialysis is offered either free or at a subsidised rate of ₹ 375 to patients, says a note on its website.

Of the 16 centres run in Tamil Nadu by Tanker Foundation, 11 are in Chennai. “A majority of the patients are enrolled under the Chief Minister Scheme and if expenses beyond that need to be covered we find donors,” says Dr. Georgi Abraham, founder-president of the Tanker Foundation.

The patients have the choice of

opting for a centre that is closest to their home. “A patient whose kidney function is between 6 and 8 percent is eligible for dialysis, but we are particular that certain criteria are met including the financial background of the person and dialysis in an OP setting for free treatment,” says Dr. Georgi.

With rising number of kidney-related ailments, the Foundation sees a huge demand for this from of service. People who require early detection are those with high BP, history of diabetes, complaints of heart disease and a previous history of kidney disease.

For details about its various centres, visit <https://tankerfoundation.org>

***GCC-run centres

Greater Chennai Corporation runs dialysis centres in a majority of its zones. As per data put up on X, Zone IX has the maximum number of dialysis machines, 22. The unit functions from Vallorkottam Diagnostic Centre in Nungambakkam. Others are in Thiruvottiyur UCHC, Lakshmiapuram in Retteri UPHC, Elango Nagar UPHC, Padi Ambattur UCHC, Chinnai Porur in Valsarvakam UCHC; Perungudi, Injambakkam and Semmacherry UCHC;

These centres are operated with the support of NGOs and organisations. Dialysis treatment is offered free-of-cost at these centres.

Care at ₹ 600

Since Chennai Lions Dialysis Foundation started in Thiruvanniyur in 2011, one thing that has stayed constant is its affordable pricing. In all these 15 years, the Foundation charges ₹ 600 per sitting from those seeking dialysis.

Started as a pet project of Lion R. Ravichandran, Past District Governor, the Foundation offers dialysis treatment for close to 250 people a month at its six-bed dialysis centre.

The cost of a single haemodialysis session ranges from ₹1800 to ₹ 3,500 in city hospitals. “Since patients need to undergo dialysis sessions two to three times a week, the monthly cost of treatment can run into several thousand rupees. We started this service to alleviate some of the hardships faced by dialysis patients and their families,” says Ravichandran.

The remaining costs are covered by the Foundation. “Although we do face shortage of funds we have somehow been able to sustain this service with the support of donors,” he says.

Nephrologist R. Vijay Kumar is the consultant guiding the Foundation.

Chennai Lions Dialysis Foundation is at No 28A, South Mada Street, Thiruvanniyur, near Marundeeswarar Temple.

For details, call Ravichandran at 98410 51480/ Kalyani Ngarajan at 9841115984.

**Celebrating Madras Day
(August 22), Resilience
Series tracks old
markets and enterprises
in the city that are
under the shadow of a
major civic
infrastructure work but
are soldiering on with
inimitable poise.**



“New customers find it difficult to notice the shop, while the old ones find it difficult to reach the shop.”

‘Cooking up’ a challenge for women chefs

Over 70 participants took part in this competition designed to test their culinary knowledge and kitchen skills

BY A SPECIAL CORRESPONDENT

This dish came to India from Indonesia, according to famous food historian KT Achaya. Cooks employed by Indonesian Hindu kings are believed to have made it between the 9th and 12th centuries. Name the dish.

* Designed by chemist Fred Baur using advanced computing to solve issues with broken and greasy-bagged snacks, this product's signature saddle-like shape is a mathematically optimised hyperbolic paraboloid. It comes packed in canisters to withstand transport pressure. Which engineered snack brand is this?

These two are among the questions that were posted to participants at QuizDiva, a culinary competition for women chefs, culinary professionals, and hospital-



The winners along with dignitaries at the event.

ity students from South India, held at Institute of Hotel Management in Taramani recently.

Over 70 participants found their knowledge and culinary skills tested through different rounds. There were three top prizes worth ₹ 1 lakh, ₹75,000 and ₹ 50,000 to be taken away.

Designed to celebrate talent, creativity, and professional excellence, the event organised by X Quiz IT with South India Chefs Association (SICA) as collaborators

tested the participants on practical culinary challenges, knowledge of food and kitchen skills.

The quiz segments were conducted by X Quiz IT's founder and creative head Arvind Rajeev, while the overall event was handled by Arun Jayakaran Ventures (AJV). "We have done quiz competitions for chefs in the past but this is the first time we were doing something exclusively for lady chefs who were in the fray to showcase their expertise in theo-

ry and practicals. We wanted them to look beyond the books," says quizzier Arvind Rajeev.

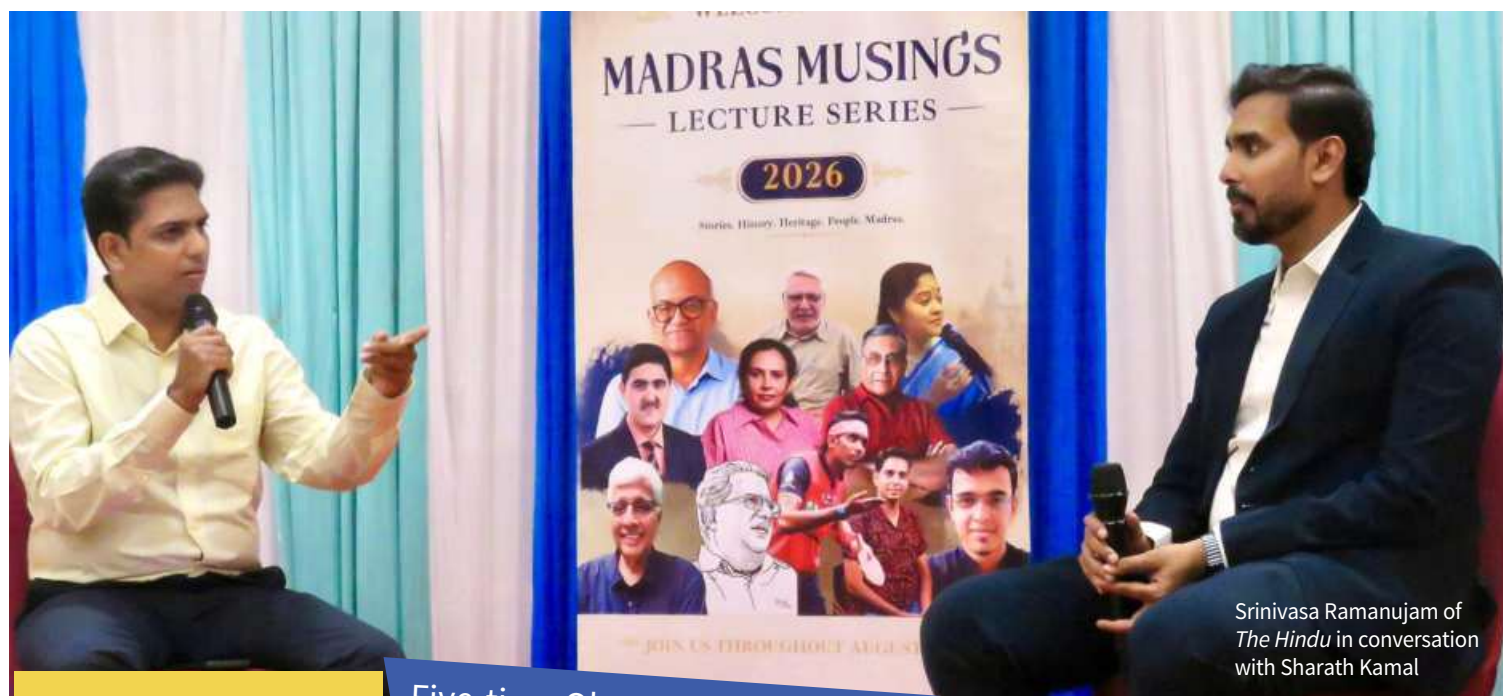
With women in the hospitality industry playing an important role, QuizDiva served as a platform for recognising and encouraging them.

Niranjana Murugesan Durai, a resident of Chennai, won the first prize. After a stint in the hotel industry, she is currently running her own home-based cloud kitchen and plans to use the cash

prize in her business.

Rubah Fathima and Nandhita Sriram were declared second and third prize winners respectively. A new experience for these chefs, the winners pointed out that having a quiz format in the challenge made them take "strategic guesses" and also admire the many female chefs in the industry.

Actor Thalaivasal Vijay was the special guest and he gave away the prizes.



Five-time Olympian and table tennis legend Sharath Kamal shares his Madras memories

From tracks to table

When table tennis champion Sharath Kamal watched *MS Dhoni: The Untold Story* (2016), he was almost in tears. Much like Dhoni, the now-popular paddler was once a railway TTE at the

Mambalam station in Madras. "There is a scene in the film that has Sushant Singh Rajput (who played Dhoni) sitting in a bench, watching trains go by and wondering if he would remain a ticket collector all his life. I have sat in sta-

tions in Madras exactly like that, before I saw success in table tennis," recalled Sharath.

One of India's most celebrated table tennis players, Sharath went down memory lane at 'The Sporting Side', part of the talks hosted by Madras Musings celebrating Madras Day.

In conversation with Srinivasa Ramanujam, Deputy Editor of *The*

Hindu (Metroplus), the five-time Olympian spoke about the times when he would cycle from Choolaimedu to Mylapore to attend training sessions. "I owe a lot of my success to the city's thriving table tennis culture. I had so many champions to look up to. The club culture here - where we focus on overall growth rather than just individual sporting growth - helped me hone my skills," he recalled.

Sharath, who studied at Padma Seshadri Bala Bhavan and Loyola College, went on to represent India at the highest level, becoming a force to reckon with in the world table tennis circuit. "I have always been a proud Chennaiite. During the time when I lived and trained in Europe, primarily Germany, I would miss the city and my mother's cooking a lot."

Now retired from table tennis, the champion is actively looking at giving back to the sport that gave him name and fame. Part of that will be his involvement in a High Performance centre at Melkottaiyur, a training facility dedicated to grooming future champions. "My unfulfilled dream was to win an Olympic medal for India in table tennis. We hope to achieve that through the younger generation of table tennis talents."

MGM Healthcare performs robot-assisted knee replacement surgery



MGM Healthcare Malar, Adyar, has successfully performed a robot-assisted simultaneous bilateral total knee replacement on an 81-year-old patient with severe osteoarthritis, deformity, and multiple comorbidities.

The patient's persistent knee pain had worsened over the past few months, and she had become increasingly dependent on others. When it became difficult even to take a single step, she sought care at various hospitals. Given her age and comorbidities, she was started on medications.

Upon admission to MGM Healthcare Malar, Adyar, doctors diagnosed her with severe bilateral knee osteoarthritis. The patient also had severe comorbidities, including diabetes, coronary artery disease, a respiratory infection, and severe anemia.

A medical team led by Dr. Shriram Krishnamoorthy, senior consultant, Orthopedics, Joint Replacement and Robotic Surgery, successfully performed the high-risk surgery. A multidisciplinary team comprising experts from Orthopedics, Pulmonology, Cardiology, Internal Medicine and Anaesthesiology worked together to optimize the patient's condition before surgery.

The team performed the surgery with the assistance of a computer-guided robotic arm to ensure utmost precision and accuracy. The patient started walking without support within a couple of days. The patient also received comprehensive multidisciplinary post-operative care, including physiotherapy, anticoagulation, diabetic management, respiratory care, nutritional support, and additional blood transfusions to address post-operative anemia.

Cycle rally to explore Perambur



Madras Week celebration at KRM Public School, Sembium, commenced with a cycle rally to explore Perambur, one of the oldest settlements in Chennai.

The rally was organised with two key objectives: to appreciate the rich history and heritage of Perambur and to spread awareness about fitness.

Called "Namma Ooru Perambur," the rally began from the school and covered several significant landmarks, including Perambur Board, Lakshmi Amman Temple, Vivekananda School, Kaligi Ranganathan Monford Matriculation Higher Secondary School, Perambur railway station, Narmuga Vinayagar Temple, ICF factory, Loco Bridge, Railway Mazdoor Union Church and the Venus



Students of KRM Public School, Sembium, during the rally.
PHOTOS: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Gandhi Statue.

Around 150 students participated in the six-km rally called which was flagged off by Krishnakumar, Sub-Inspector of Police, Thiru Vi Ka Nagar Police Station. Personnel of Thiru Vi Ka Nagar and Sembium

police stations supported the event by ensuring safety.

The students shared their experiences with their peers, expressing their happiness at discovering the historical treasures and heritage of their neighbourhood.

Cultural events mark I-Day celebration



Various cultural events marked Independence Day celebration at Kola Saraswathi Vaishnav Senior Secondary School. Kindergarten students were dressed up as national leaders and freedom fighters. The students narrated the stories of India's freedom struggle.

Tamil Nadu School Education Minister Rajmohan was the chief guest, says a press release.

Baking workshop

Tamil Nadu Agricultural University Information & Training Centre is conducting a workshop on mushroom cultivation on August 27. Another workshop on baking of cakes will be held on August 28. According to a press release, there will be demonstrations on making tea cake, banana walnut cake, ragi cake, gulab jamun cake, and coconut cake.

Both the sessions will be held at the centre's premises at Agro Tech Green Park, First Floor, Thiru. Vi. Ka. Industrial Estate, Guindy. Prior registration is required. For details, call 044 - 29530048

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Promising tennis players get a leg up



BY A SPECIAL CORRESPONDENT

Vijay Amritraj, former international tennis star and president of the Tamil Nadu Tennis Association (TNTA), had high praise for the Next Level Program (NLP). The ambitious player-development initiative of TNTA seeks to provide comprehensive assistance to 10 of Tamil Nadu's top junior players, enabling them to pursue their tennis ambitions at the highest level.

Speaking at a press conference in Chennai recently to launch the WTA 250 Open International women's tennis championship, to be held from November 2 to 8, the 72-year-old former Davis Cupper explained the idea behind NLP.

"You all have followed the NLP, which has been a great success so far. And it is great to see the enthusiasm that it has created for kids who want to get on board. We have an incredible sponsor (Bajaj Finserv) that has supported it. And the sky is the limit for them. We are obviously targeting the four grand slams in the junior category," Vijay remarked.

The NLP kids are proving that they are making slow and gradual progress. At the recently concluded Junior National clay court championships at the Madras Cricket Club courts, NLP kids won all the four titles -- boys' singles, girls' singles, boys' doubles and girls' doubles.

Launched in January 2024, NLP was conceived as a long-term

player-development initiative by Amritraj and conceptualised and implemented by Rajeev Vijaykumar, who was brought in to lead player development at TNTA. Rajeev also serves as the Director and Head Coach of NLP.

"The support", highlighted by the release by NLP, "provided includes technical and on-court training, physical conditioning and fitness, mental and performance development, tournament travel and competition support, equipment and tennis accessories and mentorship and long-term player guidance.

According to the release, NLP is inspired by the highly successful Britannia Amritraj Tennis Program of the 1980s and 1990s, while adapting the model to the needs of today's players. Unlike the earlier program, NLP does not have a residential component and focuses exclusively on promising players from Tamil Nadu.

Some of the players who have benefited from NLP and performed well are Rethin Pranav Senthil Kumar, Diya Ramesh, Deepshika Vinayagamurthy and G. Rohit Hari Balaji. While Rethin participated in all the four junior Grand Slam tournaments in 2025, Diya took part in the Australian Open Juniors in 2026. Rohit Hari Balaji won the boys' singles title at the National juniors, while Deepshika Vinayagamurthy clinched the girls' singles title. Deepshika and Diya Ramesh won the girls' doubles crown and Rohit Hari Balaji and Srikanth Doni from Karnataka won the boys' doubles title.

Coffee House opens third outlet in Nungambakkam

Cafe Coffee House has opened its third outlet, located on Dr Thirumoorthy Nagar Main Road, near GG Hospital, Nungambakkam.

The evening launch was marked by music and special offers, bringing together family, friends, and influencers.

The menu at the outlet includes burgers, pizzas, sandwiches, wraps, pasta, fried chicken, seafood, grilled dishes, and snacks, as well as coffee and other beverages.

Kishore, the outlet founder, says the idea of opening a cafe outlet stemmed from an experience when he was studying in college.



"During my college days, menus at cafes were expensive and would cost around ₹350. My

pocket money at the time was around ₹100-₹150. The outlet will offer a café-style experience at more approachable prices."

Sadya at Sangeetha Veg Restaurant



On August 26, Sangeetha Veg Restaurant is serving the traditional Onam sadya.

The sadya will feature crisp banana chips, 'sarkara upperi', 'pachadi', 'thoran', 'kootu curry', 'olan', 'kalan' and 'inji puli', along with pickles, 'pappadam', 'pazham', 'parippu' and 'nei', more 'kachiyathu' and other accompaniments. The feast culminates in the irresistible 'pradhaman'.

The Onam sadya at Sangeetha Veg is served at its three outlets - Adyar (9003003087), Virugambakam (7823958667), and Anna Nagar (8680001379) from 11 a.m. to 3 p.m. Dine-in bookings can be made at No. 9003003090. Customers can also book for takeaway and home delivery within a 3-kilometer radius. The Onam sadya can also be ordered online through Swiggy and Zomato, said a release.



JSP Honda conducts service camp for CSD customers

JSP Honda held a free CSD service camp at the showroom on Independence Day.

The camp was conducted exclusively for CSD customers to provide hassle-free service and ensure their Honda Big Wing motorcycles remain in good condition.

More than 25 customers attended the camp and availed of services such as general check-ups, washing, bike polishing, chain lube, and an expert technical inspection by Honda-certified technicians.

The initiative received an overwhelming response from CSD customers, who appreciated the dedicated support and convenience offered on a National Holiday. The service team ensured personalized attention for every vehicle.

Speaking about the camp, the JSP Honda team stated that these service initiatives aim to strengthen customer relationships and reinforce Honda's commitment to after-sales service excellence.

An awareness run on ill effects of drugs

The Nazareth Group of Institutions organised a run at Nazareth College of Arts & Science, Kovilpathagai, Avadi, to spread awareness on the ill-effects and dangers of using illegal drugs. According to a press release, the event aimed to promote a drug-free society.

The run was conducted in 10K, 5K, and 3K categories and also a special category in which differently-abled persons and children with special needs took part, adds the press release.

R. Ramesh Kumar, MLA, Avadi Assembly Constituency, and families of the college students took part.



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